Betsy & Steve — Complete Bridge Conventions

Betsy & Steve Convention Card

ACBL-Style Convention Card

General Approach

System: Standard American | **5-card majors** | **1st–4th seat**

Notrump Openings

Bid	Range	Responses	Notes
1NT	15–17 HCP	Stayman; Jacoby Transfers; Texas Transfers	Range **announced**; Stayman **announced**; transfers **announced**
2NT	20–21 HCP	Stayman; Jacoby Transfers	Range **announced**

After opponent interference over 1NT: see detailed notes

Major Openings (5+ cards, 1st–4th seat)

Response	Points	Support	Notes
Simple raise (2M)	6–9	3+	
Bergen 2M	4–6	4	**Alertable**
Bergen 3♣	10–12	4	**Alertable**
Bergen 3♦	7–9	4	**Alertable**
Double raise (3M)	0–3	4	Preemptive; **alertable**
3NT	13–15	3	Balanced, 3-card support; **alertable**
Jacoby 2NT	13+	4	Game forcing or better; **alertable**
Splinter	13+	4	Singleton/void; **alertable**
Drury 2♣	Medium+	3	Passed hand only; **alertable**
Drury 2♦	Medium+	4	Passed hand only; **alertable**

Minor Openings (3+ cards each)

Response	Points	Notes
Inverted single raise	11+	Forcing; no 4-card major; **alertable**
Double raise	0–9	Preemptive/weak, **alertable**

Two-Level Openings

Bid	Points	Shape	Responses	Notes
2♣	22+	Any	2♦ = waiting	
2♦ / 2♥ / 2♠	5–11	6-card suit	2NT = forcing inquiry (**alertable**)	

Overcalls

Simple (1-level): 8–15 HCP; new suit by advancer is non-forcing constructive

Jump overcall: Intermediate — sound when vulnerable, light when non-vulnerable

NT overcalls: - Direct 1NT: 15–18 HCP, systems on (Stayman, transfers) — range **announced** - Balancing 1NT: 12–14 HCP — range **announced** - Jump to 2NT: 2 lowest unbid suits (Unusual 2NT) — **alertable**

Michaels Cuebid: Alertable - Over a minor: both majors - Over a major: other major + a minor

Doubles

Type	Through	Notes
Negative	3♠	**Alertable**
Support	2♠	**Alertable**; support redouble also applies
Takeout vs. preempts	4♠	

Slam Conventions

RKC Blackwood: 1430 — 5♣ = 1 or 4 key cards; 5♦ = 0 or 3 — **alertable**

Defense vs. Opponent's 1NT

Landy: 2♣ = 5/4 or better in both majors — **alertable**

Carding

- **Primary signal:** Attitude, then suit preference
- **vs. trump suit:** Lead A from AK

Other Conventions

- **New Minor Forcing:** After 1m – 1M – 1NT, 2♣ or 2♦ = forcing, asks about opener's shape — **alertable**

Alertable and Announced Bids Summary

> **Announced** = partner describes the bid aloud. **Alerted** = partner says “Alert” and waits for opponent to ask.

Announced (partner describes aloud):

Bid	What partner says
1NT opening	“15 to 17”
2NT opening	“20 to 21”
Jacoby Transfer (2♦/2♥ over NT)	“hearts/spades”
Texas Transfer (4♦/4♥ over NT)	“hearts/spades”
NT overcall	State the range

Alerted (partner says “Alert”):

Bid	Situation
Bergen 2M	4-card support, 4–6 pts
Bergen 3♣	4-card support, 10–12 pts
Bergen 3♦	4-card support, 7–9 pts
Double raise (3M)	4-card support, 0–3 pts (preemptive)
3NT response to major	3-card support, 13–15 pts (balanced)
Jacoby 2NT	Game-forcing raise, 4-card support
Splinter	Game-forcing raise, singleton/void
Drury 2♣	Passed hand, 3-card support
Drury 2♦	Passed hand, 4-card support
Inverted minor raise	Forcing, 11+ pts, no 4-card major
2NT response to weak 2-bid	Forcing inquiry
Support double	Shows exactly 3-card support
Support redouble	Shows exactly 3-card support
New Minor Forcing	After 1m – 1M – 1NT
Landy 2♣	Over opponent’s 1NT opening
Michaels cuebid	Cuebid of opponent’s opening suit
Unusual 2NT	Jump to 2NT over opponent’s opening
RKC 4NT	When agreed as Blackwood

Convention Reference

Fully Documented

Convention	What it covers
Major Raises	Bergen, Jacoby 2NT, Splinter, Drury
Inverted Minors	Single raise of opener’s minor
Defense vs. 1NT Interference	After double or suit overcall over partner’s 1NT

Stub Files — Needs Content

Convention	File
Stayman, Jacoby Transfers, Texas Transfers	NTResponses.md
Support Doubles / Redoubles	SupportDoubles.md
RKC 1430	RKC1430.md
New Minor Forcing	NewMinorForcing.md
Landy	Landy.md
Michaels Cuebid	MichaelsCuebid.md
Unusual 2NT	Unusual2NT.md

Not Yet Adopted

- Help suit / game try suit
- Fourth Suit Forcing
- Additional defense vs. opponent’s 1NT (beyond Landy)

Notrump Responses

Covers responses to 1NT (15–17) and 2NT (20–21) openings.

Stayman

Used to find a 4-4 major-suit fit after a NT opening.

When to use: - Responder has at least one 4-card major - Enough points to be interested in game (or slam)

Auction: 1NT – 2♣ (Stayman); 2NT – 3♣ (Stayman)

Opener rebid	Meaning
2♦	No 4-card major
2♥	4+ hearts
2♠	4+ spades

After 2♦ (no major): *(fill in — what does responder do next?)*

Jacoby Transfers

Used to transfer to a major suit after a NT opening, putting the stronger hand as declarer.

Auction: 1NT – 2♦ → opener bids 2♥; 1NT – 2♥ → opener bids 2♠

Responder bids	Transfers to
2♦	Hearts (opener bids 2♥)
2♥	Spades (opener bids 2♠)

Super-accepts: *(fill in — does opener ever jump with a great fit?)*

After the transfer: *(fill in — what are responder's rebid options? e.g., pass, raise, bid 2NT/3NT, new suit)*

Texas Transfers

Used to transfer directly to game in a major, usually with a long suit and enough for game but no slam interest.

Auction: 1NT – 4♦ → opener bids 4♥; 1NT – 4♥ → opener bids 4♠

Responder bids	Transfers to
4♦	4♥ (game in hearts)
4♥	4♠ (game in spades)

When to use Texas vs. Jacoby: - Texas: game values, no slam interest, 6+ card major - Jacoby: game or slam possible, or need to describe hand further

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Responses to 2NT (20–21)

(fill in — Stayman, Jacoby Transfers, point ranges for game/slam, etc.)

Major Raises

General Approach

- Use Bergen to show 4 card support
- Use Splinter to show game-forcing 4 card support with a singleton or void. Usually the singleton or void is not an honor.
- Use Jacoby 2NT to show game-forcing **or better** 4 card support
- Use Drury with a passed hand to show 3+ card support and at least a minimum hand

When to choose splinter or Jacoby 2NT

- A splinter usually is limited in point range to less-than-slam. It puts your partner in control of deciding how high.
- Because your honors are usually not in the splinter suit, partner could potentially explore slam if there’s a good fit in other suits and they don’t have many HCP in the splinter suit.
- Jacoby 2NT can be slam-worthy. It puts you in control of deciding how high.

Splinter Bids

A splinter is a **double-jump shift** in the short suit, showing game-forcing support for opener’s major.

Requirements: - 4-card support for opener’s major - 13+ total points (HCP + distribution) - A singleton or void in the splinter suit (usually not an honor)

How it works: - The splinter bid identifies your short suit, letting opener evaluate how useful their high cards are in that suit - Wasted honors (K, Q) in your short suit are bad news; low cards or voids there are good - Opener is in control of how high to go

Splinter vs. Jacoby 2NT: - Use a splinter when you are likely game-forcing but not slam-certain — you want partner to evaluate - Use Jacoby 2NT when you are slam-worthy and want to be in control of the slam decision - A hand with a void is often better described by Jacoby 2NT (since partner may not realize how powerful a void is without more information)

After a splinter: - Opener signs off at game with wasted values in the short suit - Opener cuebids or bids 4NT (RKC) with interest in slam

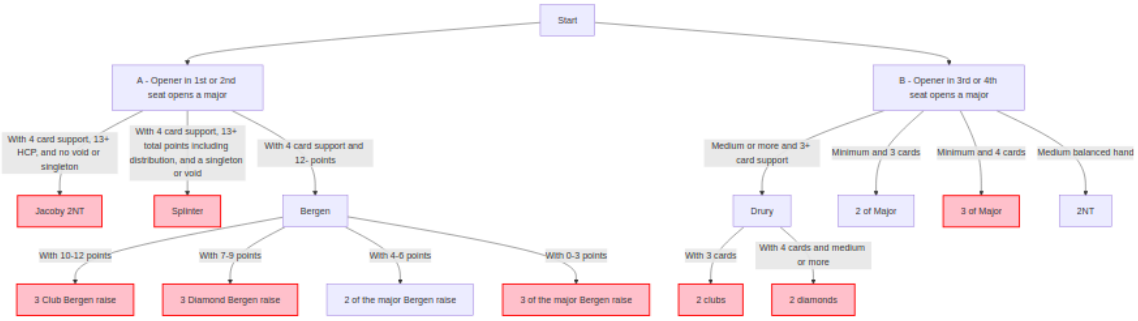

Diagram 1

Alertable

Inverted Minors

General approach:
- Opener bids a minor.
- Responder has no 4 card major but 4+/5+ cards in the opener's minor and 11+ points
- Goal is to explore No Trump by figuring out which suits are stopped, or short-circuit to the minor if No Trump isn't viable - Once inverted minor is bid, the working assumption is that both minors are stopped unless someone bids the other minor

Inverted Minor - Clubs

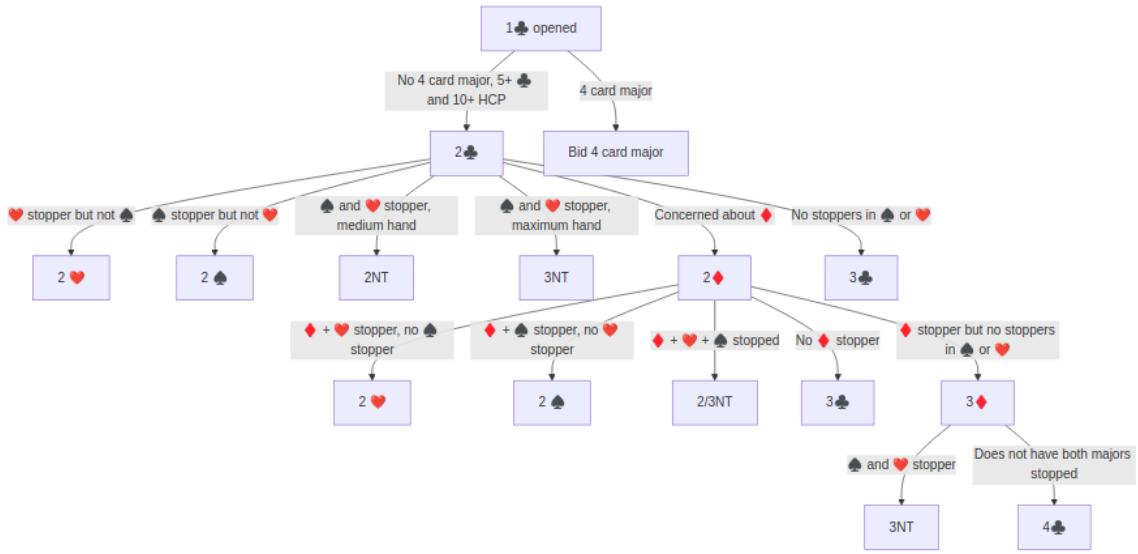

Diagram 1

Inverted Minor - Diamonds

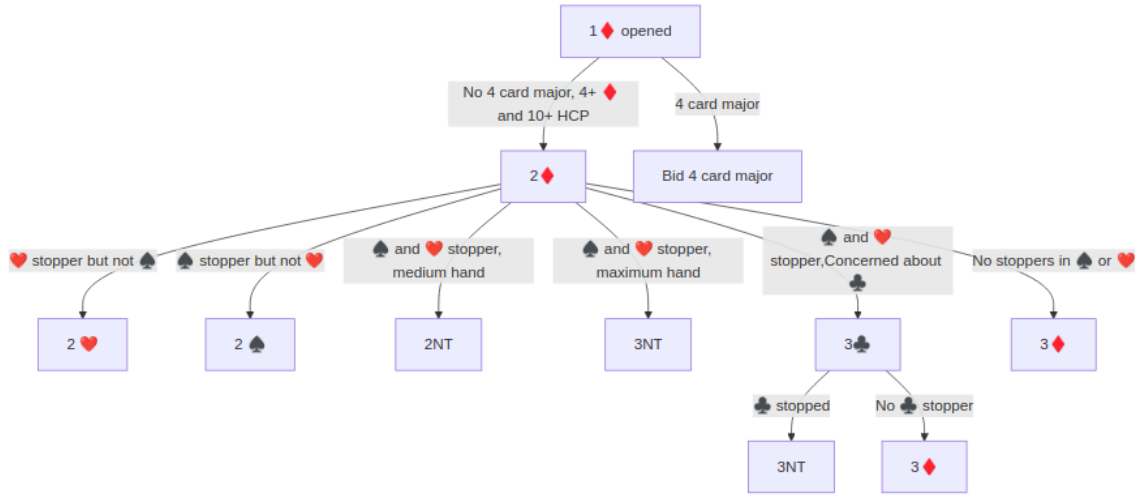

Diagram 2

Sample Hands

Board 1

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ♠, but not ❤, so bids 2♠
4. South has ❤ and 14hcp, so bids 3NT

Board 2

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ❤, but is not sure about ♠, so bids 2❤
4. South has a stopper in ♠ with the K, and 14hcp, so bids 3NT

Board 3

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ❤ and ♠, but is concerned about the singleton low ♣, so bids 3♣
4. South has a stopper in ♣ so bids 3NT

Board 4

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♣
2. South bids 2♣
3. North has a stopper in ❤, but is not sure about ♠, so bids 2❤
4. South has a stopper in ♠ with the A, and 12hcp, so bids 2NT

5. North has 14hcp, so bids 3NT

Board 5

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. South has a maximum so bids 3NT

Board 6

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♣
2. South bids 2♣
3. North has a stopper in ❤️, but not ♠️, so bids 2❤️
4. South has a stopper in ♠️ and 12hcp, so bids 2NT
5. North has 14hcp, and takes it to 3NT

Board 7

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With only a minimum hand, south passes

Board 8

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North has too many hcp to open 1NT and not enough for 2NT. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North isn't too interested in NT because of the distributional power of the hand. North knows they have at least 10♦ and can find at least 17 total points if you include the length in ♦. If North bids 4NT they might get too high and have to play in 6♦, so North bids 5♦

4. With 11 hcp, the bare minimum, south passes.

Board 9

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1 ♦️
2. South bids 2 ♦️
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With 14hcp, north takes it to 3NT

Board 10

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1 ♦️
2. South bids 2 ♦️
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With only a minimum hand, south passes

Board 11

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1 ♦️
2. South bids 2 ♦️
3. North has a ton of points. We are certainly at least in game. North can still force bidding to continue and learn more about south's hand. With no stopper in ❤️, north bids ♠️.
4. South has ❤️ and 12hcp, so bids 3NT
5. North knows they have slam potential in NT now. North bids a quantitative invite of 4NT.
6. With only 12hcp, south is pretty close to the minimum for their bids so far, so south passes.

TODO: Annotate below this line

Board e

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, but is concerned about the singleton low ♣️, so bids 3♣️
4. South has a stopper in ♣️ so bids 3NT

Board f

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With 14hcp, north takes it to 3NT

Board g

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦
2. South bids 2♦
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, but is concerned about the singleton low ♣️, so bids 3♣️
4. South has a stopper in ♣️ so bids 3NT

Board h

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♣️
2. South bids 2♣️
3. North has a stopper in ❤️, but not ♠️, so bids 2❤️
4. South has a stopper in ♠️ and 12hcp, so bids 2NT
5. With 12hcp south passes

Board i

Board j

Board k

Board l

Board m

Board n

Board o

Board p

Board q

Board r

Board s

Board t

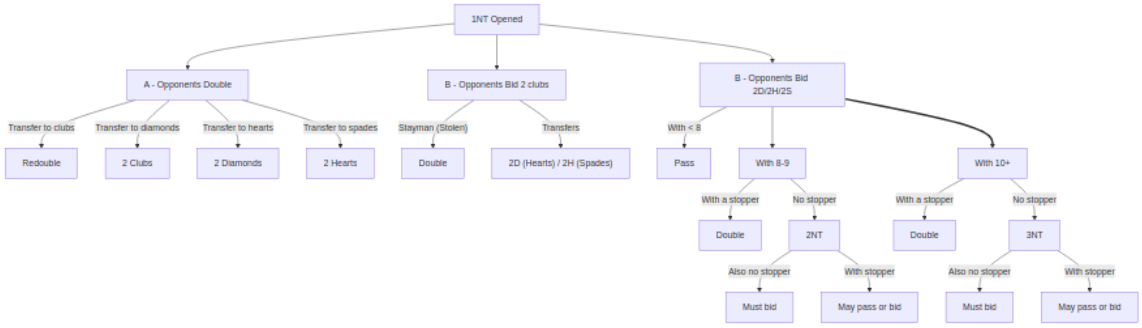
1NT Opened
A - Opponents Double
B - Opponents Bid 2 clubs
B - Opponents Bid 2D/2H/2S
Transfer to clubs
Transfer to diamonds
Transfer to hearts
Transfer to spades
Stayman (Stolen)
Transfers
With < 8
With 8-9
With 10+
Redouble
2 Clubs
2 Diamonds
2 Hearts
Double
2D (Hearts) / 2H (Spades)
Pass
With a stopper
No stopper
Double
2NT
With a stopper
No stopper
Double
3NT
Also no stopper
With stopper
Must bid
May pass or bid
Also no stopper
With stopper
Must bid
May pass or bid

Diagram 1

Support Doubles and Redoubles

Used by opener to show 3-card support for responder's major when opponents interfere.

Support Double

When it applies: Opener has opened, responder bid a major, and an opponent overcalls (through 2♠).

Auction example: 1♣ – (P) – 1♥ – (1♠) – **Dbl** = opener has exactly 3 hearts

Opener's action	Meaning
Double	Exactly 3-card support for responder's major
Raise to 2M	4-card support

Why it matters: Responder now knows whether to expect 3- or 4-card support when bidding game or slam, which affects how they evaluate their hand.

Range for support double: *(fill in — is there a point range, or does it apply regardless?)*

After the support double: *(fill in — what does responder do next?)*

Support Redouble

When it applies: Same situation as the support double, but the opponent **doubles** instead of overcalling.

Auction example: 1♣ – (P) – 1♥ – (Dbl) – **Rdbl** = opener has 3-card support for hearts

Opener's action	Meaning
Redouble	3-card support for responder's major
Raise to 2M	4-card support

Applies through: 2♠ (same as support double)

Notes

(fill in — any edge cases, e.g., what if opener has already limited their hand? Does it apply in competition?)

Roman Keycard Blackwood (RKC 1430)

Used to count key cards (the four aces plus the king of trumps) before bidding slam.

The Ask

4NT = asking for key cards (must have a clearly established trump suit)

The “1430” naming refers to the responses:

Response	Key cards held
5♣	1 or 4 key cards
5♦	0 or 3 key cards
5♥	2 key cards, **no** trump queen
5♠	2 key cards, **with** trump queen

The Queen Ask

After a 5♣ or 5♦ response, the next step asks for the queen of trumps.

(fill in — what is the queen ask bid? How does partner respond?)

The King Ask

After confirming key cards (and the queen), 5NT asks for kings.

(fill in — how are kings shown? Do you show specific kings or just count?)

When to Use RKC

- Trump suit must be clearly agreed (or implied by the auction)
- Asker should be confident of no two fast losers in any suit
- Typically used when investigating slam

When NOT to Use 4NT

(fill in — e.g., when 4NT is quantitative, when a suit hasn't been agreed, etc.)

Notes

(fill in — any partnership-specific agreements, e.g., exclusion Blackwood, kickback, etc.)

New Minor Forcing

Used by responder after a 1NT rebid by opener to ask about opener's shape, particularly major-suit length.

When It Applies

Auction: 1m – 1M – 1NT – 2♣ or 2♦ (the *other* minor = new minor)

- Responder bids the **unbid minor** as an artificial, forcing bid
- Does **not** show clubs/diamonds — it's asking opener to describe further

Requirements for responder: - Invitational or better values (typically 10+ HCP) - Wants more information before placing the contract

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Opener's Responses

(fill in — what does opener show with each rebid?)

Opener rebid	Meaning
2M (responder's major)	3-card support
2♥ (if spades was the major)	4 hearts
2NT	Minimum, no 3-card major support
3M	3-card support, maximum
3NT	Maximum, balanced

After Opener Responds

(fill in — what are responder's options?)

What Is NOT New Minor Forcing

(fill in — e.g., if responder's minor is the same suit that was opened, or other auction shapes that look similar)

Notes

(fill in — any edge cases or partnership agreements)

Landy

Defense convention used over an opponent's 1NT opening.

The Convention

2♣ over opponent's 1NT = at least **5/4 in the majors** (hearts and spades)

- The 2♣ bid is artificial — it does **not** show clubs
- Shows at least 5 cards in one major and 4 in the other
- Typically a hand that is not strong enough to double (penalty)

Responses by Partner (Advancer)

(fill in — what does advancer do?)

Advancer bid	Meaning
2♥	Preference for hearts (could be a doubleton)
2♠	Preference for spades (could be a doubleton)
2NT	*(fill in)*
3♣	*(fill in — natural? asking for better major?)*

Point Range / Strength

(fill in — how strong does the Landy bidder need to be? Any vulnerability considerations?)

What About Other Defenses?

(fill in — do you use any other bids over opponent's 1NT, e.g., doubles, other suit bids?)

Notes

(fill in — any partnership-specific agreements)

Michaels Cuebid

A cuebid of opener's suit to show a two-suited hand.

The Convention

After an opponent opens 1 of a suit, a **direct cuebid** (2 of opener's suit) shows a specific two-suiter:

Opponent opens	Your cuebid	Shows
1♣	2♣	Both majors (5+ hearts and 5+ spades)
1♦	2♦	Both majors (5+ hearts and 5+ spades)
1♥	2♥	Spades + an unspecified minor
1♠	2♠	Hearts + an unspecified minor

Point Range / Strength

(fill in — what is the HCP/suit quality range? Any vulnerability adjustments?)

Identifying the Minor (After Major + Minor Cuebid)

When the cuebid shows a major + unknown minor, partner can ask:

(fill in — how does partner find out which minor? e.g., 2NT = ask)

Responses by Partner (Advancer)

(fill in — what are partner's options after a Michaels cuebid?)

Advancer bid	Meaning
2M (known major)	Preference, not forcing
3M (known major)	Invitational
4M (known major)	To play
2NT	Asks for the minor (if applicable)

Notes

(fill in — any edge cases, e.g., direct vs. balancing seat, passed hand Michaels, etc.)

Unusual 2NT

A jump to 2NT over an opponent's opening bid to show the **two lowest unbid suits**.

The Convention

2NT (jump) over an opponent's opening = 5+ cards in each of the two lowest unbid suits

Opponent opens	Your 2NT shows
1♥	Clubs and diamonds (the two lowest unbid suits)
1♠	Clubs and diamonds
1♣	Diamonds and hearts
1♦	Clubs and hearts

Point Range / Strength

(fill in — what is the HCP/suit quality range? Any vulnerability adjustments?)

Responses by Partner (Advancer)

(fill in — what are partner's options?)

Advancer bid	Meaning
3 of lower suit	Preference, not forcing
3 of higher suit	Preference, not forcing
3 of opponent's suit	*(fill in — forcing? game invite?)*

Unusual 2NT vs. Natural 2NT

(fill in — when is a 2NT bid natural vs. unusual? e.g., after a weak 2-bid by opponents)

Notes

(fill in — any partnership-specific agreements, e.g., strength requirements, vulnerability adjustments)